

N O T T E R A

# Your Pillow Guide

How to prepare your Nottera pillow, which side to sleep on,  
and how to keep it at its best — in the first week and the  
years after.



Better days begin the night before.

# The first forty-eight hours

Give your pillow a little time before you judge it. Memory foam settles into itself — and the pillow you unwrap is not quite the pillow you will sleep on.

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## 48h

If your pillow arrived compressed in its packaging, lay it flat and allow up to forty-eight hours to return to its full shape. Either way, give it two nights before forming an opinion — memory foam is temperature-sensitive and feels firmer in a cold room until body heat reaches it.

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### 1 Unwrap it the day it arrives

Remove all packaging, including the inner plastic. The foam cannot begin to recover its shape while it is still sealed.

### 2 Let it breathe

Lay it flat and uncovered in a room with moving air — not in direct sun, not on a radiator. If it arrived compressed, this is when it recovers its shape. New foam can also carry a faint manufacturing scent; it is harmless and disperses as the pillow airs out.

### 3 Warm it through

If it feels firmer than expected, it is almost certainly the temperature, not the foam. Body heat softens it within minutes of lying down.

### 4 Dress it

Add your pillowcase once the pillow has fully expanded. Every Nottera case is cut to the contour, so it should slip on without stretching or flattening the shape.

Give it two nights before you decide. Almost everyone does.

# Which side is yours

You chose Crescent (55 × 35 cm). Your pillow has two lofts — a higher side and a lower one. The right choice comes down to a single question: how wide is the gap between your head and the mattress when you lie down?

10 / 7 cm

The high side measures 10 cm, the low side 7 cm. Turn the pillow over to switch — there is no wrong way up, only two different heights for two different nights.

| HOW YOU SLEEP       | START WITH | WHY                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| On your side        | 10 cm      | Your head has to clear the full width of your shoulder. Side sleeping needs the most loft of any position.                           |
| On your back        | 7 cm       | Enough height to hold the natural curve of the neck, without tipping the chin toward the chest.                                      |
| On your stomach     | 7 cm       | The flattest option, so the neck is not held at an angle for hours at a time.                                                        |
| A bit of everything | 10 cm      | Start high. It is easier to notice a pillow that is slightly too tall than one that is too low.                                      |
| Broad shoulders     | 10 cm      | Whatever your position. Broader shoulders open a wider gap between head and mattress — and that gap is what the loft exists to fill. |

IF YOU WAKE WITH A STIFF NECK

Flip to the other side and give it a full week. 3 centimetres is a larger correction than it sounds.

HAVE THE ECLIPSE, NOT THE CRESCENT?

Eclipse (60 × 40 cm) runs a taller loft — 12 cm on its high side, 2cm more than Crescent. The guidance above is scaled to the pillow you actually have.

The aim is a straight line from ear to shoulder — nothing more complicated than that.

# Which side is yours

You chose Eclipse (60 × 40 cm). Your pillow has two lofts — a higher side and a lower one. The right choice comes down to a single question: how wide is the gap between your head and the mattress when you lie down?

12 / 10 cm

The high side measures 12 cm, the low side 10 cm. Turn the pillow over to switch — there is no wrong way up, only two different heights for two different nights.

| HOW YOU SLEEP       | START WITH | WHY                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| On your side        | 12 cm      | Your head has to clear the full width of your shoulder. Side sleeping needs the most loft of any position.                           |
| On your back        | 10 cm      | Enough height to hold the natural curve of the neck, without tipping the chin toward the chest.                                      |
| On your stomach     | 10 cm      | The flattest option, so the neck is not held at an angle for hours at a time.                                                        |
| A bit of everything | 12 cm      | Start high. It is easier to notice a pillow that is slightly too tall than one that is too low.                                      |
| Broad shoulders     | 12 cm      | Whatever your position. Broader shoulders open a wider gap between head and mattress — and that gap is what the loft exists to fill. |

IF YOU WAKE WITH A STIFF NECK

Flip to the other side and give it a full week. 2 centimetres is a larger correction than it sounds.

HAVE THE CRESCENT, NOT THE ECLIPSE?

Crescent (55 × 35 cm) runs a lower loft — 10 cm on its high side, 2cm less than Eclipse. The guidance above is scaled to the pillow you actually have.

The aim is a straight line from ear to shoulder — nothing more complicated than that.

# Living with it

A new pillow changes how your body is held at night, and the body takes a few nights to accept the correction. After that, the care it needs is almost nothing.

## 7 nights

Most people feel the difference immediately. Allow up to a week for the muscles that have been compensating for an unsupportive pillow to settle into the new alignment — the first two nights are not the verdict.

### THE COVER

Unzip it and machine wash cold on a gentle cycle. Air-dry it rather than tumbling — it comes back softer, and the knit keeps its stretch.

### AIRING IT

Once a month, strip the case and leave the pillow in a ventilated room for a few hours. It is the single habit that most extends its life.

### THE FOAM CORE

Never soak, wash or wring it. Water breaks down the cell structure permanently. Spot-clean with a damp cloth and let it air out fully, away from direct sun.

### STORING IT

Keep it flat and uncompressed. Long periods folded or vacuum-packed can leave a set the foam does not fully recover from.

- ☐ Do not iron, bleach or dry-clean the cover.
- ☐ Keep the pillow out of prolonged direct sunlight — UV degrades foam over time.
- ☐ A high-density core holds its shape for years, not months. Replace it when it stops recovering its contour, not on a schedule.

Care for it once a month, and it will care for you every night.

# Three habits worth the effort

A pillow removes one source of friction. These three habits — drawn from the research in our full guide — address the rest, and cost nothing at all.

## 1 Ten minutes of morning light

Step outside within an hour of waking. Morning light advances your body clock, which is what makes you sleepy at a reasonable hour tonight. A window costs you most of the intensity — go outdoors.

## 2 An eight-hour caffeine cut-off

In controlled trials, 400 mg of caffeine taken six hours before bed still cut measured sleep by over an hour — and most participants never noticed. The cost is paid in deep sleep, quietly.

## 3 A warm shower, ninety minutes early

Not before bed — well before it. The warmth is not what helps; the rebound cooling afterwards is, and it takes about ninety minutes to arrive.

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### The Nottera Sleep Guide

Those three pages are drawn from a twenty-nine page guide: the science in plain terms, the six habits quietly working against you, a seven-night method and a thirty-day record — every figure sourced from peer-reviewed research.

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A good pillow makes a good night easier. It does not make a bad one good.

# Sources

Every figure in this guide is drawn from peer-reviewed research or professional consensus.

- 01 Watson NF et al. (2015). Recommended amount of sleep for a healthy adult: joint consensus statement of the American Academy of Sleep Medicine and Sleep Research Society. *SLEEP*. — The seven-hour recommendation.
- 02 Drake C et al. (2013). Caffeine effects on sleep taken 0, 3 or 6 hours before going to bed. *Journal of Clinical Sleep Medicine*. — 400 mg six hours before bed reduced measured sleep by over an hour.
- 03 Haghayegh S et al. (2019). Before-bedtime passive body heating and sleep: a systematic review and meta-analysis. *Sleep Medicine Reviews*. — The ninety-minute warm shower window.
- 04 Published research on pillow loft and cervical muscle activity during sleep. — The loft range associated with the lowest measured neck-muscle tension.
- 05 Professional consensus from sleep clinicians on neutral cervical alignment across sleeping positions. — The head, neck and spine held in a neutral line.

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Nottera pillows are consumer comfort products, not medical devices, and are not intended to diagnose, treat, cure or prevent any condition. Nothing in this guide is medical advice or a substitute for care. If neck pain, daytime sleepiness or disrupted sleep persists, please see a qualified clinician.

Better days begin the night before.